for preparing intelligence for the IDF for future wars. Territorially speaking, MI gathers intelligence from within the State of Israel and abroad. The Mossad is responsible for intelligence gathering for MI, as well as for its own operations and for special operations: that is, any operation for the State of Israel that no other body is capable of carrying out. Finally, the Shin Bet, which is responsible for internal security, fighting subversive activities of any kind and engaging in counterespionage, operates within the borders of the State of Israel.

It is important to note that at its inception the intelligence community consisted of three intelligence services, of which only the most senior—MI—developed research and evaluation capabilities from the very beginning. The other two services dealt mainly with intelligence gathering and did not have research and evaluation capabilities, with the exception of intelligence research on their operations.

In the community's early days, a mechanism was built to direct intelligence collection. Since MI was the only service that also conducted research and assessments, it was natural for it to be the one to identify and define Israel's threats and translate them into EEI (Essential Elements of Information) to then be distributed to the Mossad and the Shin Bet, who were "subcontractors" of MI in everything related to responding to the national EEI.

The intelligence collection system between MI and the Mossad and Shin Bet created a very interesting symbiosis over time. At first, the process was one-way: Military Intelligence would brief the other two services and give them assessments of the material they had provided as well as more briefings; the Mossad and the Shin Bet would then brief MI with specific information regarding the operations they were responsible for, and MI would provide them with relevant intelligence from its sources.

Over time, MI researchers understood the potential of the other two services' sources and asked to assess not only the information they provided but also the quality of the sources themselves. The assessment of the sources was an important tool for the two intelligence-gathering services—the Mossad and the Shin Bet. It evolved from a one-time event to a periodic, annual, and special assessment mechanism.

At a later stage, MI's intelligence collection system assigned a representative of its own, a midlevel officer, as an attaché to the Mossad's HUMINT unit. The permanent presence of an MI officer in the Mossad